

# Chapter 1

## Meet the Business

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PLACEHOLDER FILE — replace /public/chapter-1-placeholder.pdf with the approved Chapter 1 PDF, then update site.chapterOneUrl in src/lib/site.ts.

The first meeting was scheduled for an hour and ran for two, and almost none of that time was spent on the numbers.

It was spent arguing about whether the numbers were right. The sales figure on the screen did not match the figure the sales head had presented four days earlier. The inventory value had moved by an amount nobody could explain.

This is where almost every one of these engagements begins. Not with strategy. Not with a growth plan. With the uncomfortable discovery that the reporting the business has been steering by is somewhere between incomplete and wrong.

[Full chapter text to be supplied by Finnpulse Advisors.]